SEPHARDIC COMMUNITY ALLIANCE

Minhag of the Week

*Sephardic Community Alliance · "Preserving Our Rich Heritage, One Minhag at a Time"*

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EPISODE 159

# Tefilla BeSibbur: Sefer Torah of Shabbat Minha

By Joey Harari · Jun 8, 2022

*Dedicated in loving memory of Louis Shamie A"H, Eliyahu Ben Salha, by his wife and children*

Shalom UBerakhah from Yerushalayim. We have been discussing the Minhagim of the prayers of Minhah of Shabbat in the synagogue. We have completed through VaAni Tefillati in our last video, and now we are on page 338, if you wish to follow, in the Kol Ya'akob. We are ready to take the Sefer out in order to read the Torah on Minhah of Shabbat, and generally, the customs are the same in taking out the Sefer. The Mesader will invite someone for Petihah, for Jilyan to carry the Sefer open to the Tebah, and for the 'Aliyot.

There are a couple of small differences between taking the Sefer Torah out of in Shahrit and in Minhah. So if you notice in the Kol Ya'akob it says "Bikssat Kehillot Omerim Kan," some congregations recite the Berikh Shemeh. Now, I understand that today most Kehillot, most Minyanim, do indeed say the Berikh Shemeh, but it is the scope and intent of this video series to bring you the Minhagim as they were in Halab and as they were in the early part of our history in Brooklyn. The Berikh Shemeh was not recited in Halab, and even growing up, I do not recall it being said on a consistent basis in most Kehillot. In fact, in the book Derekh Eress compiled by Hakham Abraham Ades, he brings down specifically that we do not say Berikh Shemeh during Minhah, and on my last trip to Deal, I had the opportunity to speak with Hakham Edmond Nahum, Yizzakher LaTob, and he confirmed to me that in Halab they did not say Berikh Shemeh in Minhah of Shabbat.

We take out the Sefer with "Se'enah URe'enah," "Barukh HaBa BeTorat Ad-onai," "VeZot HaTorah Asher Sam Moshe" until the Pasuk "Ad-onai Hafess LeMa'an Sidko Yagdil Torah VeYa'dir", while the one who has the Jilyan is carrying the Sefer to the Tebah.

Now, I did want to point out during the discussion of Minhah of Shabbat something which is a very, very important practice that was always done in our community, and it involves people who are receiving honors from the Mesader, whether it be Petihah, carrying the Sefer, or the 'Aliyot. They always wore a jacket. Now, usually in Shabbat morning it's not an issue, but the last number of years which I've been in New York I've noticed that there's a more casual attire being worn to Minhah of Shabbat, and I recall very, very clearly was a very pronounced Minhag that anybody who had an honor, if someone, let's say, was invited for an 'Aliyah and he didn't have a jacket, it

was a scramble. People would take their jacket off and make sure he gets a jacket that fits him, and he goes up to the Sefer, and it was a beautiful display of reverence and the Kabod that we have for our holy Torah. And I think it's a beautiful custom, and it left a very big impression on me, and it's a custom which we should continue to do.

After the third 'Oleh, he does not say Kaddish. Instead, the Hazzan will say "Mizmor Shir LeYom HaShabbat." Following Mizmor Shir, the one who brought the Sefer out will now return the Sefer to the Hekhal open, as is our custom and as clear that that is our custom. The Kahal will say "Yehalelu Et Shem Ad-onai Ki Nisgab Shemo Lebaddo," a series of Pesukim on page 332, ending with "VaYira VaYomar Mah Nora HaMakom HaZeh En Zeh Ki Im Bet Elokim VeZeh Sha'ar HaShamayim". Kol Tub.

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*(Disclaimer: This is a transcript of a video episode and may contain spelling or grammatical errors. As this transcript was generated from video, it may not fully capture the speaker's tone, emphasis, or intent — we recommend watching the video for the full experience and accuracy.)*